4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: September 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

September 2026 Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

Services

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Gross margin = revenue less contractors and consultant time charged to the work at $60 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: consultant time not charged to clients, and overheads (management and admin wages, marketing, rent, IT, insurance, travel, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

September's client work made $81,890 gross margin (56.3%). Consultant time not charged to client work took $14,352 and overheads $52,140, leaving $15,398 profit before tax (10.6% of revenue). To cover overheads, client work needs a 45.8% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on client work	$81,890
Consultant wages and on-costs	$60,192
Consultant time charged to client work (at cost)	$45,840
Consultant time not charged to client work	$14,352
Gross profit (the P&L)	$67,538
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$52,140
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$15,398
Revenue	$145,330
Gross margin on client work, %	56.3%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	10.6%
Gross margin client work need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**45.8%**

Type of work: All

September against September last year
121.4%
$145,330 against $65,650

Year to date against the same period last year
77.6%
$405,285 against $228,200

Gross margin, year to date
61.1%
$247,545 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 77.6% up on the same period last year, year to date ($405,285 against $228,200). Retainers make the highest gross margin (63.4%); Projects the lowest (60.0%). The business needs 45.8% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Projects: 60.0% gross margin, 20.0 points over the 40.0% target ($53,451 ahead on $266,685 this financial year to date). Retainers: 63.4% gross margin, 23.4 points over the 40.0% target ($25,080 ahead on $107,100 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Projects

September against September last year
125.5%
$94,830 against $42,050

Year to date against the same period last year
70.8%
$266,685 against $156,100

Gross margin, year to date
60.0%
$160,125 before overheads

What it shows
Projects brought in $266,685 this financial year to date, 70.8% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 77.6%), at a 60.0% gross margin (below the 61.1% overall).

What you'd do about it
Projects: 60.0% gross margin, 20.0 points over the 40.0% target ($53,451 ahead on $266,685 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Retainers

September against September last year
99.4%
$35,700 against $17,900

Year to date against the same period last year
99.4%
$107,100 against $53,700

Gross margin, year to date
63.4%
$67,920 before overheads

What it shows
Retainers brought in $107,100 this financial year to date, 99.4% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 77.6%), at a 63.4% gross margin (above the 61.1% overall).

What you'd do about it
Retainers: 63.4% gross margin, 23.4 points over the 40.0% target ($25,080 ahead on $107,100 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Training

September against September last year
159.6%
$14,800 against $5,700

Year to date against the same period last year
71.2%
$31,500 against $18,400

Gross margin, year to date
61.9%
$19,500 before overheads

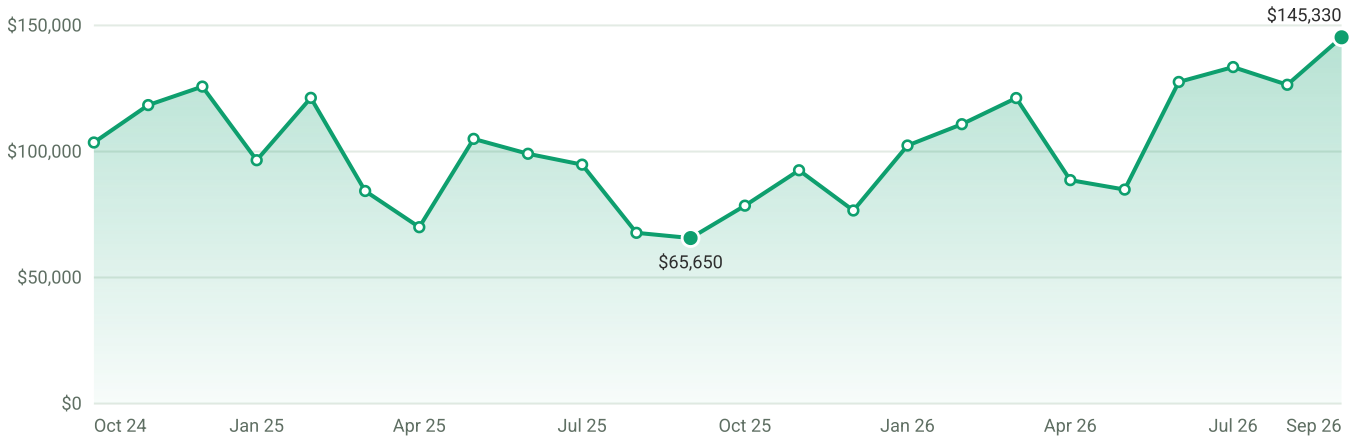
What it shows
Training brought in $31,500 this financial year to date, 71.2% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 77.6%), at a 61.9% gross margin (above the 61.1% overall).

What you'd do about it
Training: 61.9% gross margin, 21.9 points over the 40.0% target ($6,900 ahead on $31,500 this financial year to date).

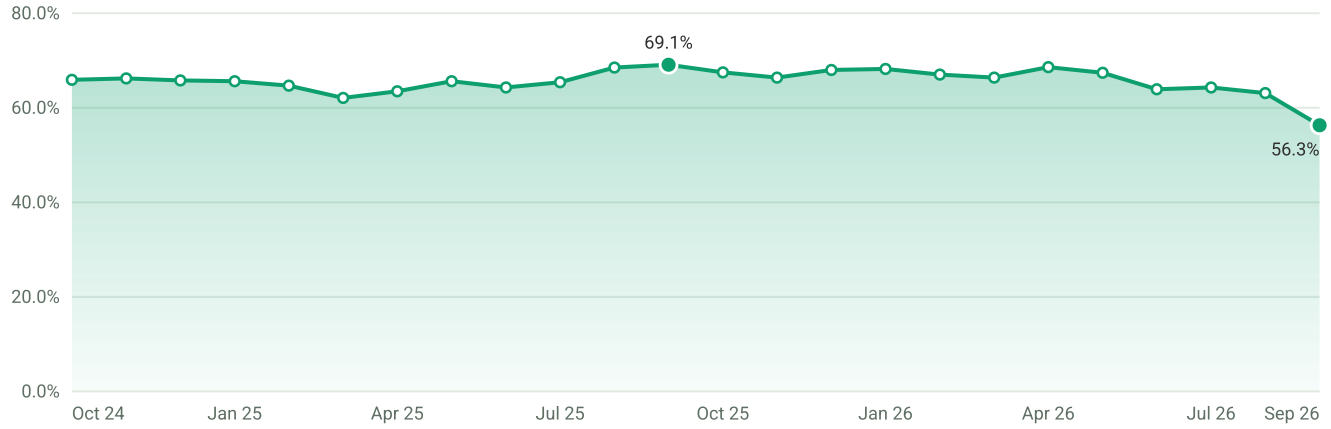
Every type of work at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by type of work, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By type of work: financial year to date (Jul to Sep 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Projects	$266,685	$156,100	70.8%	$160,125	60.0%
Retainers	$107,100	$53,700	99.4%	$67,920	63.4%
Training	$31,500	$18,400	71.2%	$19,500	61.9%
Total	$405,285	$228,200	77.6%	$247,545	61.1%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.